

Breaking Free From Spiritual Control

Written by:

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DEDICATION

To the ones who were silenced, shamed, or exiled for thinking differently—

This is for you.

To my parents—

May truth reach you louder than fear ever did.

And to the manipulators—

You don't own our souls. Not then. Not now. Not ever.

EPIGRAPH

“You nullify the word of God for the sake of your tradition.”

— *Matthew 15:6*

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and brought the matchbook.*

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FOREWORD / AUTHOR'S NOTE

“They Tried to Own My Soul—But I’m Still Here.”

I didn’t write this book for likes, followers, or fake claps from religious puppets. I wrote this because something had to be said. Because too many of us are getting played—by a system wearing God’s name like a mask.

This is not about hating God. Don’t get it twisted. I believe in a higher power—more than ever. But what I don’t believe in? These spiritual institutions that hijack people’s minds and make them slaves in the name of “faith.” These manipulative pastors, priests, and preachers who speak like they’re holy—but act like they’re above the people they’re supposed to serve.

They got my parents, man. That one hurts. They used the Bible and the church walls to turn them against me. They planted fear, guilt, and fake promises in their hearts. And now I feel the distance. I feel like my own blood can’t see me clearly anymore—like religion blurred their vision of their own son.

This book is me fighting back.

I don’t care if I’m called a rebel, a lost soul, or a heretic. I’d rather speak my truth than live quiet while the people I love get swallowed by a system built on control.

This is for every person who felt silenced in church.
For every soul who was made to feel “not enough.”
For the ones who got kicked down instead of lifted up.
For my parents—if you ever read this, know I love you. I just need you to wake up before it’s too late.

This isn’t just a book.
It’s a bullet through spiritual chains.
It’s a middle finger to fake prophets.
It’s my soul, unchained.

Let’s break free.

—Francis Louie

Chapter 1: The Original Lie

They told us God lived in a building. They told us salvation was behind a pulpit. They told us our soul was only safe if we followed their script.

That was the first lie.

This chapter is not about denying God. It's about exposing how His name was taken and turned into a leash.

The Setup: God vs. Religion

God is real. That divine energy, that higher force, that presence that sits with you in silence—that's real. You feel it when you cry alone and someone deep inside tells you to keep going. You feel it when you look at nature, when you see your mom smile, when your soul finds peace for no reason.

Religion? That's a system.

It has rules, buildings, robes, routines, and leaders who stand above people and say they speak for God. That's not God—that's control.

The original lie is making people believe that **God and religion are the same thing**. They're not.

Verse Breakdown: The Misuse of Hebrews 10:25

"Do not forsake the gathering of the saints"

Hebrews 10:25

How they use it: They say, "See? The Bible says you have to go to church. If you don't, you're disobeying God."

The truth: This verse was written to early Christians being persecuted, scattered, scared. The message was: *"Don't give up on each other."* It wasn't about mandatory church attendance. It was about unity, not obligation.

But pastors twist this into pressure. If you miss church, they say you're backsliding. They count your attendance like it earns points with God. That's manipulation.

Spiritual Blackmail: Using Fear to Control

They say, *"If you leave the church, you're leaving God."* They say, *"If you question the pastor, you're disrespecting God's servant."* They say, *"If you don't give your tithe, you're robbing God."*

That's spiritual blackmail.

Imagine someone saying, "If you don't call me every day, you don't love me." That's not love—that's toxic. And yet religion does it all the time.

The moment faith becomes a fear trap, it stops being faith.

Weaponizing Obedience: The Misuse of Ephesians 6:1

"Children, obey your parents in the Lord, for this is right."

Ephesians 6:1

How they use it: Parents are told, "Your child must obey you, or they're disobeying God."

The truth: Obedience in the Lord means within love, respect, and truth. Not blind submission to manipulated authority. If your parents are being controlled by fear-based religion, this verse doesn't justify that.

We honor truth—not abuse disguised as faith.

When Religion Divides Families

You ever notice how religious systems divide homes?

One family member doesn't attend church? Suddenly they're the black sheep. The lost one. The one who needs to be "prayed for."

But what if the one who left actually found God beyond the walls? What if they saw through the game?

This is happening all over the world. And it's how religion keeps power: it isolates truth-tellers and labels them rebels.

But rebels built revolutions. And God never said, "Stay silent when truth is burning your chest."

The Truth They Don't Preach

God is not insecure. God doesn't need weekly validation. God doesn't need your money to move in your life. God is not sitting in a building waiting for you to dress up and sing before He listens.

He's already in your soul.

They won't preach this, because if you knew that, **you wouldn't need them.**

Final Word of Chapter 1

The original lie was saying that without **them**, you can't know **Him**.

But here you are. Still breathing. Still searching. Still connected.

You don't need permission to speak to God. You don't need a pulpit to find purpose. You don't need chains to prove devotion.

You are already enough.

This is just the beginning.

Chapter 2: Faith or Fear? The Psychology of Control

They say it's faith. But what they feed you is fear.

Faith is trust. Fear is slavery.

One empowers you. The other paralyzes you.

Let's talk about how religion took fear, dressed it up as faith, and used it to build an empire of control.

Fear-Based Doctrine: The Manipulator's Favorite Tool

Religious systems figured out something centuries ago: scared people are easier to control.

Scared of hell. Scared of demons. Scared of sin. Scared of not giving enough. Scared of questioning.

Keep them afraid, and you keep them loyal.

"The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom."

Proverbs 9:10

How they use it: They say, "See? You must fear God. That fear will keep you righteous."

The truth: The Hebrew word for "fear" here is "*yirah*" — which also means **awe, reverence, respect**. It's not terror. It's wonder. But they twisted it. They turned reverence into **spiritual anxiety**.

Now people serve out of **panic**, not love.

Fear of Hell: The Eternal Threat

From the moment you're old enough to understand words, they whisper it:

"If you die without Jesus, you're going to hell."

Not, “God loves you.” Not, “Let’s talk about truth.” But, “Burn or believe.”

That’s not faith. That’s terrorism in a holy costume.

"There is no fear in love. But perfect love drives out fear..."

1 John 4:18

You hear that? **Perfect love casts out fear.**

If a system uses fear to keep you close, it is not operating in perfect love. And if it’s not love, it’s not God.

Obedience Through Terror

"Touch not my anointed, and do my prophets no harm."

Psalms 105:15

How they use it: “Don’t question the pastor.” “Don’t speak against the church.” “If you do, curses will follow.”

The truth: This was a poetic reminder about God’s protection of His people—not a free pass for leaders to abuse power.

But they use it as a **spiritual muzzle**. You’re told to shut up, stay loyal, and fear punishment if you don’t.

Control 101.

Guilt Offering: The Weaponization of Tithing

"Will a man rob God? Yet you have robbed me... in tithes and offerings."

Malachi 3:8-10

How they use it: If you don’t give 10% of your income, they say you’re robbing God. They say your finances will be cursed. They say you’re greedy.

The truth: This was an Old Testament law for a specific nation under a specific covenant. Jesus never commanded New Testament believers to give under pressure. Giving was voluntary, joyful, and based on love—not fear.

Now? They guilt the broke into giving more, while pastors flex in luxury.

That ain't holy. That's hustle.

Fear of Isolation: The Church Cult Tactic

They make you think if you leave the church, you lose your community. Your friends? Gone. Your support system? Vanished. Your reputation? Slandered.

It's spiritual extortion.

That's why many stay—not out of faith, but out of **social survival**.

But true community doesn't punish people for leaving. Godly love doesn't ghost you because you asked hard questions.

Emotional Manipulation Disguised as Conviction

You cry during the sermon. You feel heavy. You feel scared. They call it "the Holy Spirit convicting you."

Sometimes it is. But sometimes it's psychological warfare.

They hit your insecurities, guilt, and trauma like a skilled salesman. Then they offer relief through their system. That's not faith—that's marketing.

Final Word of Chapter 2

They use fear to sell faith. They use hell to sell heaven. They use guilt to sell grace.

But fear-based obedience is not relationship. It's slavery.

And God did not make you to be a slave. He made you to be free.

So ask yourself:

Are you walking in faith? Or are you walking on eggshells?

That question might be the start of your freedom.

Chapter 3: The Pulpit and the Power Trip

Let's talk about that stage. The one raised a few feet above the crowd. Where one man stands every Sunday, mic in hand, eyes scanning the room like a king over his kingdom.

They call it the pulpit. But what it often becomes is a **power trip**.

This ain't an attack on every pastor. Some are real, humble, grounded. But too many? They feed on control, ego, and applause. And they've learned to wrap it in Scripture.

The Worship of the Pastor

You know it when you see it. The moment the crowd claps harder for the preacher than they do for God. The way people defend their leader more than they defend the truth.

It turns from faith into **fan club**.

"Touch not my anointed"

Psalms 105:15

Used like a shield. A verse-armor that lets pastors dodge accountability. But God didn't write that for megachurch celebrities in Gucci suits. He wrote it to protect His people from unjust harm.

Calling out corruption is not "touching God's anointed." It's protecting the flock from wolves.

When the Mic Becomes a Throne

Some pastors don't preach. They perform. They pause for applause. They build catchphrases. They repeat them like branding.

And the crowd eats it up. Because charisma hypnotizes. And when people are spiritually hungry, the loudest voice in the room becomes their meal.

But don't confuse volume for truth. Don't confuse stage presence for divine presence.

"Beware of false prophets, who come to you in sheep's clothing but inwardly are ravenous wolves."

Matthew 7:15

They don't always look like villains. Sometimes they look like motivational speakers. Sometimes they sound like TED Talks with a few verses sprinkled in.

But the message always serves one thing: **them.**

Power Over People

They decide who's blessed. They decide who gets the mic. They decide who's "falling away" and who's "under God's covering."

It ain't just leadership anymore. It's dictatorship.

And they hide it behind "spiritual authority."

But **real authority doesn't demand loyalty.** It earns respect. Real authority isn't loud. It's consistent.

"The greatest among you shall be your servant."

Matthew 23:11

If your leader flexes more than he serves, If he silences more than he listens, If he loves his image more than your soul,

You're in the presence of ego, not anointing.

Ego in the Name of Jesus

Let's call it what it is. Some of these pastors are addicted. Not to porn. Not to money (though that too). But to **power. To praise. To being followed.**

And the pulpit gave them their fix.

They get high off honor. They manipulate your loyalty. They make you feel like being close to them is being close to God.

That's not ministry. That's a cult.

They Call It "Spiritual Covering"

"You can't operate in your calling without a covering."

Translation? **You can't do anything unless you submit to me.**

But God never said His Spirit flows through middlemen. The veil was torn. You have **direct access** to the throne.

Covering doesn't mean control. It means community.
Accountability. Not authority-over-your-identity.

When They Preach Submission, But Demand Worship

Ever notice how they keep hammering "submit to leadership"? But never talk about their own submission?

Submission should be mutual. Love-based. Truth-based. Not fear-driven and rank-based.

Church was never meant to be a pyramid. It was a **circle of believers** with Jesus at the center.

But they put themselves in the center. And God in the background.

Final Word of Chapter 3

The pulpit isn't evil. But put the wrong heart behind it, and it becomes a **stage for spiritual dictatorship.**

Don't worship preachers. Don't fear leaders. Don't confuse control with calling.

God didn't send you to serve a man. He called you to walk with Him.

The power trip ends when we stop handing them the keys. Time to take back your faith.

Chapter 4: Family as a Weapon – When Belief Divides Blood

They say family is forever. But what happens when religion rewrites that? What happens when belief systems become battle lines?

Let's talk about it.

Because some of the deepest wounds aren't from enemies. They're from family who suddenly see you as one.

When Faith Becomes a Filter

You were raised together. Same roof. Same meals. Same laughter.

But the moment you questioned the system— or stepped away from the church— or said, "I don't believe that anymore"

Suddenly, you're the problem. You're "lost." You're "rebellious." You're a **threat** to their version of peace.

Not because you changed your love. But because you changed your **mind**.

The Weaponization of Doctrine

Religious leaders don't need to argue with you directly. They just need to **whisper into your family's ears**.

"Pray for them, they're under spiritual attack." "Don't let their spirit influence yours." "The devil uses family, be watchful."

Now your mom, your dad, your cousins— they don't see your face anymore. They see a warning sign.

All because you dared to think for yourself.

How They Create the Divide

It's subtle.

- A pastor preaches obedience to "spiritual authority"
- Your parents start quoting him, not God
- Every disagreement turns into, "You need to repent"
- Every silence becomes, "We're praying for you to come back"

It feels like **you left them**, but really, **they were taught to leave you** emotionally.

Loyalty to Church Over Blood

They go to church every week. But won't sit down to hear your side of the story once.

They tithe, serve, attend, and obey, but they struggle to hear your heart without filtering it through their pastor's latest sermon, whether preached on Sunday, Saturday, or whichever day they gather for worship.

It's not faith. It's **indoctrination**.

And it's breaking homes while calling it "spiritual warfare."

The Pain of Parental Silence

You try to explain. You try to reach out. But your words hit a wall built from Bible verses and borrowed fear.

You're still their child. But somehow you became their **spiritual project**, not a person with your own mind.

They think they're saving you. But they can't even **see you** anymore.

But You're Still Here

You didn't walk away to be distant. You stepped back to breathe. To think. To reconnect with **God directly**, without the noise.

That doesn't make you a prodigal. That makes you **awake**.

"Do not suppose that I have come to bring peace to the earth. I did not come to bring peace, but a sword. For I have come to turn — 'a man against his father, a daughter against her mother.'"

Matthew 10:34-35

Even Jesus knew: **Truth divides before it unites.**

Keep Loving Them

Even when it hurts. Even when they parrot sermons instead of speaking from the heart. Even when they treat you like a stranger wearing their child's face.

You love them. Not because they understand. But because **you remember who they are beneath the fear.**

That love? That's the real faith.

Final Word of Chapter 4

They used family as a weapon. But you still carry love like a shield.

You're not fighting them. You're fighting for them.

Because one day they might see past the doctrine, past the division, and realize **you never left them. You just stopped letting religion come between you.**

Chapter 5: Facebook Prophets & Digital Puppets

Let's get real, G. In the age of Wi-Fi and smartphones, the pulpit went digital. And now? Everyone with a ring light and a Bible app thinks they're a prophet.

But this ain't prophecy. It's performance. And our elders? They're the first to get caught in the net.

Welcome to the Algorithm Church

Scroll your feed long enough, and you'll see them:

- The crying pastor with the shaky phone cam
- The loud rebuke disguised as a "word from God"
- The viral sermon clip cut to the juiciest soundbite

It ain't God going viral. It's **ego farming likes** in the name of Jesus.

These so-called "prophets" don't know your name. But they want your **clicks, your shares, your fear.**

Feeding Fear to Stay Relevant

"God told me someone watching this is battling demons..." "If you don't share this post, are you even saved?" "Sow a seed of \$77.77 and watch your miracle come tomorrow."

Let's call it out: **That's not faith. That's manipulation.**

They preach uncertainty to hook you, Then sell certainty wrapped in a donation button.

That ain't prophecy. That's **spiritual clickbait.**

Our Parents Are the Target

Our generation might scroll past it. But our parents? They click. They watch. They forward it on WhatsApp.

Because they trust anything with a Bible verse. Because they weren't trained to spot digital deception.

So they let strangers online become their new shepherds. Strangers who know exactly what verses to twist, what fears to stir, and what guilt to weaponize.

The Pastor in the Pocket

Used to be, pastors only preached in church. Now they're in your living room, kitchen, and even your phone.

And that ain't always bad. Truth can travel faster. But so can **toxic theology and ego gospel**.

These digital preachers don't need accountability. They don't have elders or boards. They just have views.

And in the algorithm world? Views = validation.

Red Flags of a Digital Manipulator

- Everything they post is dramatic or fear-based
- They always ask for money—**always**
- They speak in vagueness like a horoscope
- They never point to God without pointing back at themselves

They want followers, not disciples. They want **influence**, not transformation.

And they use your parents' faith as the leash.

Real Prophets Don't Need Wifi

Look at the real ones in Scripture: Jeremiah, Isaiah, Jesus Himself— they spoke truth that got them hated, not hyped.

"Woe to you when everyone speaks well of you, for that is how their ancestors treated the false prophets."

Luke 6:26

If a prophet is trending, If their whole brand is built on emotions and edited clips, You might not be hearing from God. You're hearing from a content creator with a cross necklace.

Don't Let Algorithms Raise the Elders

G, this is the mission: We gotta help our parents **decode the digital manipulation**.

Teach them how to question:

- Who is this person?
- Are they under any accountability?
- Is this truth, or just theatrics?
- Does this bring peace or pressure?

Because if we don't teach them how to scroll with discernment, They'll be taught to fear with every swipe.

Final Word of Chapter 5

Social media gave preachers a stage without a sanctuary. But not every sermon deserves a share.

Don't let Facebook prophets replace real faith. Don't let your parents become **digital puppets** in someone else's spiritual hustle.

God doesn't need Wi-Fi to speak. But these fakes need your signal just to survive.

Unplug the lie. Reconnect to the Source.

Truth doesn't trend. But it sets you free.

Chapter 6: You Don't Need a Building to Find God

Let's break this lie wide open: You don't need stained glass, fog machines, or pews to talk to God. You don't need a preacher's permission or a Sunday morning service to feel the Spirit.

God ain't boxed in. Never was.

Where Did We Get This Idea?

Somewhere along the way, religion taught us:

- "This building is holy."
- "Only ordained leaders can guide you."
- "If you stop attending church, you stop walking with God."

But that's not what the Bible says. That's not what truth feels like. That's just tradition dressed up as salvation.

"The Most High does not dwell in houses made with human hands." *Acts 7:48*

So why are we acting like the church is the only address God uses?

You Are the Temple

Church isn't a place. It's a **people**.

And more than that? It's **you**.

"Do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit within you?" *1 Corinthians 6:19*

So if you carry the Spirit inside you, Why are they telling you to chase it in a building?

Why are they acting like God goes missing between Sundays?

Nature Is a Cathedral

Some of the realest prayers you'll pray won't be under a steeple. They'll be under the stars. In your room at 2AM. While walking. Crying. Breathing.

God doesn't need a program. He meets you in your pain, your silence, your confusion.

Unfiltered. Raw. Real.

Religion Needs the Building—Not You

You ever notice how hard they push attendance?

- "Don't forsake the assembly!"
- "The enemy isolates."
- "You need to sit under a covering."

Translation? They're scared to lose their control. Their offering. Their influence.

It's not always about your soul. Sometimes, it's about their system.

Faith Without a Stage

You don't need a sermon to validate your spirituality. You don't need worship music to cry real tears.

Your conversations with God in the quiet? They count.

Your healing that came in solitude? It's valid.

They said you backslid because you left the building. But maybe you just **walked out to finally meet God without a middleman.**

What About Community?

Community is powerful. But it doesn't have to be corporate. It doesn't need stage lights or collection plates.

Find people who don't judge your questions. Who don't measure your worth by your Sunday or Saturday schedule.

Two honest souls talking about life and God? That's church.

Final Word of Chapter 6

You are not lost because you left the church building. You are not broken because you don't attend service.

God is not GPS-locked. He shows up where hearts are open, not where doors swing wide.

So if you've been told you walked away from faith just because you walked out of a building, remind them:

God never needed walls to reach a soul. Only religion did.

Chapter 7: Letters to My Parents

This chapter isn't written with fists. It's written with a heartbeat.

Yeah, I'm angry. But underneath that anger is **grief**. Under the grief? **Love**.

Because I still see you—Mom. Dad. And I miss who we were before religion came between us.

Letter One: To My Father

You taught me how to be strong. But when I started thinking differently, suddenly I was "lost." You told me to fear God. But what I feared more was losing **you**.

I needed your wisdom, not just your verses. I wanted to have hard talks, man to man—not pastor to prodigal.

But every time I spoke truth, your silence felt like rejection.

You used to say, "I got your back, son." Now it feels like you only stand behind pulpits.

I still need my father. Not the church's version of one.

Letter Two: To My Mother

You prayed over me when I was sick. Held me when I cried. Told me I was special.

But now when I ask questions, you look at me like I'm a stranger. Like I'm someone else's child.

I see the fear in your eyes. Not fear for my soul—but fear of what your church might think.

You don't need to protect God from me. God already knows my heart.

And I wish you did too.

Letter Three: If You Ever Read This

I didn't write this book to attack you. I wrote it because **I want to find you again.**

Not in religion. But in relationship.

We don't need to agree to love. We don't need to worship the same way to have peace at the table.

I still believe in God. I just don't believe in a God who would pit blood against blood.

I hope one day, you'll see that I didn't walk away from faith. I walked away from **man-made filters** around it.

Final Word of Chapter 7

If this book ever lands in your hands, know that every word came from a place deeper than rebellion.

It came from a place of wanting to **rebuild**. To love you freely. And to show you:

Your child didn't leave God. Your child just left the chains.

Chapter 8: How to Deprogram — Breaking the Mental Chains

They taught you to fear questions. To treat doubt like a disease. To confuse obedience with holiness.

But it's not rebellion to reclaim your mind. It's resurrection.

Step 1: Question Everything They Told You Not To

Start where they told you "never go." Ask:

- Who benefits from this teaching?
- Is this from God, or from men trying to control?
- Would a loving Creator want me afraid to think?

You'll feel guilt at first. That's part of the programming. Guilt is how they kept you in the cage.

But keep going. Freedom starts with a single "Why?"

Step 2: Name the Manipulation

Let's call it what it is:

- Fear-based sermons = control.
- Guilt trips = behavior programming.
- Obedience without explanation = mental slavery.

You weren't being disciplined. You were being **domesticated**.

Break that spell. When you name it, you weaken it.

Step 3: Replace Fear with Curiosity

Fear says, "Don't ask." Curiosity says, "What if?"

Fear says, "Stay in the lines." Curiosity says, "Draw your own."

Start exploring other spiritual voices. Read. Listen. Meditate. Talk to people who've been where you are.

You're not backsliding. You're upgrading.

Step 4: Reclaim Your Inner Voice

Religion trains you to outsource your voice:

- "Let the pastor interpret."
- "Wait for confirmation."
- "Submit to spiritual authority."

But guess what? **You have authority too.** The Spirit in you isn't junior. Your discernment is divine.

Start listening inward again. Start trusting that sacred whisper.

Step 5: Detox the Shame

Shame was their weapon. Not God's.

Real conviction leads to growth. But shame? Shame just paralyzes.

Throw away the lies like:

- "You're a disappointment to God."
- "You're cursed for leaving."
- "You're just being prideful."

No. You're being *brave*. And courage never offends truth.

Step 6: Build a New Framework

Once you break the old system, build something that actually holds you.

- Define your own values.
- Set spiritual boundaries.
- Craft a faith that includes healing, truth, and soul-freedom.

Your new foundation? Built on **honesty**, not fear.

Final Word of Chapter 8

Deprogramming doesn't mean you lose faith. It means you lose what was *never* faith to begin with.

You're not broken. You were bound. And now?

You're breaking free—with wisdom in one hand, and your soul in the other.

Chapter 9: Reclaiming the Soul — What Real Faith Looks Like

They told you walking away from their church was walking away from God. But let's be clear: **You didn't lose your faith. You just lost their control.**

This chapter is your shield. Verses in context. No manipulation. Faith with breath in it.

Let's reclaim what they tried to copyright.

What Real Faith *Ain't*

It ain't:

- Tithing out of fear
- Obeying out of guilt
- Silencing your questions to fit in
- Pretending you're "blessed" while you're breaking

They told you obedience was holiness. But **obedience without understanding is slavery.**

Jesus never manipulated with fear. He walked with the broken. He confronted power, not the wounded.

So if they made you feel like you were too messy to be loved? **That wasn't God.** That was religion in costume.

"For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power and of love and of a sound mind." *2 Timothy 1:7*

If fear built your faith, it wasn't built to last.

The Real Word, Not the Weaponized One

Let's call it out: Scripture was never meant to be a leash.

They used verses to silence your voice. To scare your parents. To justify control.

But real scripture liberates:

"Then you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free." *John 8:32*

"Beloved, do not believe every spirit, but test the spirits to see whether they are from God." *1 John 4:1*

"By their fruit you will recognize them." *Matthew 7:16*

You don't judge a tree by the way it talks about fruit. You judge it by what it actually produces: Love? Compassion? Or control?

Faith That Breathes

Real faith invites questions. It holds space for grief. It doesn't shut down your mind to awaken your spirit.

It empowers. It doesn't enslave.

And real faith? Doesn't beg you to perform. It asks you to be real.

Building It Back: Your Way

Forget what they said a walk with God had to look like. You get to build your spiritual house from scratch:

- Daily meditation, not just public prayer
- Journaling your doubts without shame
- Finding God in nature, in silence, in art
- Surrounding yourself with souls, not just systems

You don't need fog machines or fire insurance theology. **You need presence.**

Your new faith doesn't need perfection. It needs **honesty.**

Discernment Is Your Superpower

If they get mad that you ask questions? **That's your answer.**

If you're only accepted when you agree? That's not community—that's control.

God gave you a filter: It's called *discernment*. Use it.

"Test everything; hold fast what is good." *1 Thessalonians 5:21*

If the fruit is manipulation, shame, fear? **Throw the whole tree out.**

Final Word of Chapter 9

Faith was never supposed to be a leash.

It was always meant to be a lifeline.

You're not faithless. You're **finally free.**

And when they say: "You walked away from God," You look them dead in the eye and say:

"No. I walked toward Him. Without your chains."

Chapter 10: The Final Stand — I'm Still Here

You tried to erase me. Shame me. Silence me. Turn my own blood against me.

But I'm still here.

And this time, I'm not whispering. This time, I'm speaking for every soul you buried under scripture. Every black sheep you tried to exile. Every doubter you labeled dangerous.

Let's talk.

You Tried to Kill My Voice. I'm Still Here.

You told me obedience meant silence. That questioning meant rebellion. That love for my family meant bowing to your version of God.

You used my parents as puppets, Turned my circle into your cage, Twisted words until they bled guilt.

But even with the whole system aimed at me, I never lost my soul.

I survived every sermon that called me lost. I walked through every prayer that tried to bind me.

You aimed holy weapons at me. And I turned them into fuel.

The Spirit Survives the Fire

I walked away from your churches and found God in the silence. I left your altars and found healing in honesty.

You thought leaving meant falling. But I fell upward. I rose.

You said I was under attack. But I was being rebuilt.

The flames you said would consume me? They purified me.

"When you walk through the fire, you shall not be burned, and the flame shall not consume you." *Isaiah 43:2*

The Fake Kingdom Is Cracking

You built kingdoms on fear. On guilt. On submission disguised as holiness.

You turned pulpits into thrones. Worship into performance.
Ministry into manipulation.

But cracks are showing now. Because light breaks through lies.
Every time.

You say God is with you. But you don't look like Him.

"Woe to you, teachers of the law and Pharisees, you hypocrites!
You are like whitewashed tombs, which look beautiful on the
outside but on the inside are full of the bones of the dead and
everything unclean."

Matthew 23:27

"In the same way, on the outside you appear to people as righteous
but on the inside you are full of hypocrisy and wickedness."

Matthew 23:28

That's Jesus talking. Not me. You can argue with me. You can't
argue with Him.

You Can't Trademark God

You act like God lives in your logo. Like truth needs your
microphone. Like salvation wears your church's branding.

But God doesn't work for you. He never did.

“Freely you have received; freely give.”

Matthew 10:8

You sold what was never yours. Forgiveness for a fee. Belonging for behavior. Grace in exchange for silence.

But God is not for sale. And He never asked for your marketing plan.

A Letter to the Manipulators

To the pastors who built empires on fear: To the prophets who profit off pain: To the elders who silenced the young: To the churches that turned love into law:

We see you now.

You dressed your sermons in light, But your actions were darkness. You called doubt a sin, While living double lives behind the pulpit.

“On the outside you appear righteous, but inside you are full of hypocrisy and wickedness.”

Matthew 23:28

You said you spoke for God. But your voice never sounded like love.

You tried to damn us for leaving. But maybe we didn't leave faith.

Maybe we escaped abuse.

A Letter to the Ones Still Trapped

To those still sitting in pews, scared to leave: To those who pray with guilt instead of joy: To those who hear the sermon and feel nothing but shame:

You are not broken. You are not crazy. You are not faithless.

If you're questioning, it means you're alive. If you're doubting, it means you're thinking. If you're hurting, it means your soul is still sensitive.

And that's where God meets people — in the honest spaces. Not just in stained glass. Not just in choir robes. But in tears. In silence. In rebellion that leads to truth.

“Then you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free.”

John 8:32

You don't have to earn God's presence. You already carry it.

This Is My Declaration

You burned my name in your church. I carved it in heaven myself.

You erased me from your roster. But God never scratched me off His list.

You tried to kill my spirit with your holy shame. But my soul is louder than ever.

“Woe to the shepherds who destroy and scatter the sheep of my pasture!”

Jeremiah 23:1

I am not your prodigal. I am your prophet. I am not your warning. I am your witness.

I am the proof that love doesn't die just because the church rejected it. I am the voice that rose after religion tried to bury it.

I am still. Right. Here.

“Come out of her, my people, so that you will not share in her sins.”

Revelation 18:4

This book is my Exodus. My truth. My legacy.

And to every soul reading this: **You are not alone. You are not crazy. You are not damned.**

You are still here too.

Acknowledgement

To every soul who ever questioned, doubted, or walked away — this book is for you.

To those who were called rebellious for thinking, lost for leaving, or cursed for standing tall — I see you.

To my parents — I write this not to shame, but to awaken. I love you more than silence. I love you enough to tell the truth, even when it burns.

To the real ones — the friends who stood with me when religion turned its back — your loyalty lit the path.

To the manipulators — you taught me what power without love looks like. And that's why I fight. Not just for myself, but for everyone you tried to break.

To God — the real One — thank you for not being the version they preached. You never left. You never guilted. You were there in every tear, every scream, every step toward truth.

About the Author

Francis Louie isn't a preacher, pastor, or prophet — he's a soul who survived the system.

Born into a world where religion was used more like a weapon than a guide, he fought his way through manipulation, shame, and spiritual control to reclaim his voice. He writes for the ones who feel lost, not because they lack faith, but because they were never allowed to find it on their own terms.

Francis speaks truth with no filter — raw, real, and rooted in love. His mission is simple: **break chains, wake minds, and set souls free.**

This book is his fire. His letter to the world. His vow that no matter how deep the system goes, **light goes deeper.**

About the Publisher

LOUIEWOOD is more than a name — it's a movement. A voice for the unheard. A platform for truth that doesn't bow to systems or silence.

Founded by **Francis Louie Ramoso**, LOUIEWOOD publishes fearless, soul-shaking work that challenges control, exposes manipulation, and empowers the next generation to think, speak, and live free.

We don't serve religion.
We don't censor pain.
We don't dilute the truth.

LOUIEWOOD is built for those who refuse to be owned.